Sick Day Rules

Illness raises stress hormones and can spike glucose — or cause lows if you can't eat. Have a plan before you need it.

Do these every sick day

1. Take basal insulin / usual meds unless told otherwise.
2. Check glucose every 2–4 hours (more if rising).
3. Check ketones if glucose ≥250 or as instructed.
4. Sip fluids often — aim for hydration.
5. Rest; ask someone to check on you.

Call your care team if

- Vomiting or diarrhea lasting >4–6 hours
- Moderate/large ketones
- Glucose stays >250–300 despite plan
- Signs of dehydration
- Fever with confusion or rapid breathing
- You can't keep fluids down
- You're unsure about medication doses

Carb & fluid ideas when appetite is low

~15G OPTIONS

- ½ cup juice
- ½ cup regular gelatin
- 6 saltines
- ½ cup applesauce
- 1 cup sports drink**

HYDRATION

- Water, broth
- Electrolyte drinks
- Ice chips / popsicles
- Sugar-free fluids if glucose high**

MEDICINE NOTES

- Know which OTC meds are OK
- Sugar-free ≠ carb-free always
- SGLT2 users: ask about ketoacidosis risk when ill
- Never stop insulin abruptly

**Choose sugared vs sugar-free fluids based on glucose and your sick-day plan.

Type 1 / insulin users

Illness can trigger DKA even if you're not eating. Continue basal insulin. Check ketones. Follow your prescribed sick-day insulin adjustments.

Emergency now

Severe abdominal pain, fruity breath, deep breathing, lethargy, or inability to keep any fluids down — seek emergency care.